

Presenting Data Science-driven Solutions

Week 1 / Day 1

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

- 1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online
- 2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.
- 3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia
- 4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

What is Data Science

- Data science is an interdisciplinary field that uses scientific methods, processes, algorithms and systems to extract knowledge and insights from structured and unstructured data and apply knowledge and actionable insights to solve problems from data across a broad range of application domains.
- Data science is a "**concept to unify statistics, data analysis, informatics, and their related methods**" in order to "**understand and analyze actual phenomena**" with data.
- Data science is related to data mining, machine learning and big data.

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What is Data Science – cont'd

- **The field encompasses:**
 - preparing data for analysis
 - formulating data science problems
 - analyzing data
 - developing data-driven solutions
 - presenting findings to inform high-level decisions in a broad range of applications

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What is Data Science – cont'd

Data Science incorporates skills from:

- computer science
- statistics
- information science
- mathematics
- information visualization
- data integration
- graphic design
- complex systems
- Communication
- business

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Introduction

The importance of your business case

- Business cases have significant impacts on organizations.
- They help steer everything from small decisions to those that change the course of organizations forever.
- Learning how to craft best-practice business cases can set you up to be effective and efficient when you prepare them in the future.

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Introduction

- In business, resources are finite, and opportunities come at a cost.
- In pursuing profit and growth, organizations continually ask themselves several questions:
 - What projects should we invest in?
 - What products or services should we offer?
 - How do we best utilize resources?
- Answers must be supported by research, facts, and figures.

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Introduction – cont'd

- To facilitate decision-making, research, facts, and data that support certain decisions are presented as a business case.
- Business cases are critical pieces of project documentation that outline a business problem and provide options to solve it.
- The **goal of a business case** is to convince decision-makers that a particular course of action will result in the best outcome for an organization.

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Introduction – cont'd

- Business cases need to be created daily within organizations.
- They have consequences for the individual presenting it, the department and the business at large.
- As such, it's critical to understand how to create and present them effectively.

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Introduction – cont'd

- You will discover the different types of business cases, how to write a business case and how to present one.
- Example of a business case and resources to help you create your own.

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What Is a Business Case?

- A business case is typically a presentation or a proposal to an authority by an organization seeking funding, approval, or both for an activity, initiative, or project.
- A business case puts a proposed investment decision into a strategic context and provides the information necessary to make an informed decision about whether to proceed with the investment and in what form.
- It is also the basis against which continued funding will be compared and evaluated.

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What Is a Business Case? – cont'd

- The document provides the context for an investment decision, a description of viable options, analysis thereof, and a recommended decision. The recommendation describes the proposed investment and all of its characteristics, such as benefits, costs, risks, time frame, change requirements, impact on stakeholders, and so forth.
- The importance of the business case in the decision-making process continues throughout the entire life cycle of an investment: from the initial decision to proceed to the decisions made at scheduled project gates to continue, modify, or terminate the investment.
- The business case would be used to review and revalidate the investment at each scheduled project gate and whenever there is a significant change to the context, project, or business function.

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What Is a Business Case? – cont'd

Involve the Senior Responsible Officer and Engage the Audience

- The business case is ready for consideration once it has been developed. It is important to note, however, that even the best analysis and documentation will be of limited use unless the decision makers support the business case and give the necessary approvals.

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Business Case

a. What is a business case?

- Every day, hundreds of different projects take place within organizations.
- Many are business-as-usual, carried out as part of their everyday activities.
- Others are special projects that don't form part of an organization's everyday activities but are still **critical**.
- These projects may require a business case to be created.
- A business case helps decision-makers understand why a special project needs to be completed and how they should do so.

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Business Case – cont'd

b. Why create a business case?

- Business cases perform two important functions:
 - Help organizations understand project options and what each will cost in terms of time, money and opportunities lost or gained.
 - Show decision-makers that there is rigour behind certain courses of action.
- Business cases show that **decisions are based on research and facts**, as opposed to one person's opinion.
- Help justify spending, and protect project leads if something goes wrong.

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Business Case – cont'd

c. How is a business case different from a business plan?

- Business cases and business plans both help to convince key decision-makers to proceed with a certain course of action.
- Important to understand the critical differences between a business case and a business plan; and a business case and a project plan.

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	Business Case	Business Plan
What for?	Business cases help decision-makers choose between project options. They are used for strategy prioritization and internal budget approval	Business plans layout entire plans for new businesses, major changes to existing businesses or broad plans for a company's future
Who for?	Business cases are presented to the relevant internal stakeholders, including someone who can give budget approval	Business plans are presented to investors, shareholders or the senior leadership team within businesses
Focus?	Business cases have a narrower focus , including a presentation of the problem, options, finances, risks and benefits	Business plans have a broadier focus , including competitor analysis, a marketing plan and a business model presentation

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	Business Case	Project Plan
What for?	Business cases come before project plans. They present high-level options of what the project might look like and make recommendations on how the business should proceed	Project plans begin after a business case has been finalized. They present the practical ins and outs of the project, including how it will proceed and according to what timeline
Who for?	Business cases are presented to the relevant internal stakeholders, including someone who can give budget approval	Project plans are presented to project managers and any other stakeholders involved in the project's delivery
Focus?	Business cases have a broader focus : what the project might look like	Project plans have a narrower focus : exactly how the project will proceed

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Business Case – cont'd

d. What are the different types of business cases?

- Stakeholders come from different departments within a business and have different interests in the project.
- Tailoring to the differing and sometimes conflicting interests that various stakeholders can have requires a sound business case structure.
- One model that provides this structure is the **Five Cases Model**, which stipulates that a business case must be presented from five different perspectives: **strategic, economic, commercial, financial and management.**
 - **Functional, technical, environmental , security and privacy** issues are all addressed in each phase of the model.

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Business Case – cont'd

Five Cases Model

1. The Strategic Case

- The goal is to make a **case for change** and show how it strategically your project aligns with the **direction of the business**.
- Outline the business problem to be solved, detail the scope of what you are trying to achieve, and describe the benefits and risks.
- Explain how a particular process, if successful, would contribute positively to the business overall.

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Business Case – cont'd

2. The Economic Case

- The goal is to identify which of the options you are presenting provides the **best value to the business**, including broader considerations, such as **social and environmental effects**.
- This is important if you are presenting a case for a project that the **public** will interact with, such as developing a product or building a structure.
- Show that you've appraised multiple options, ruled out options based on cost and value, and then explored, in detail, what each remaining option provides.

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Business Case – cont'd

3. The Commercial Case

- Show that you can **procure suppliers** (or internal resources) and that you can do so fairly and cost-effectively.
- Anticipate the resources you need and then factor in any contingencies that might occur within the delivery of the project.

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Business Case – cont'd

4. The Financial Case

- When thinking from a **financial case perspective**, show that the business can **afford to fund** the preferred option you are presenting.
- To do so, demonstrate that you have analyzed the capital, revenue and whole-of-life costs of your preferred option. Do so in a structured manner, such as by using a profit and loss analysis or another financial ratio analysis.

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Business Case – cont'd

5. The Management Case

- The management case needs to show managerial stakeholders that **adequate plans** are in place for the **delivery, monitoring and evaluation** of your preferred option.
- Present a plan for how your preferred option will be project managed in accordance with best practices and show that independent assurance is available if required.

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Business Case – cont'd

e. How to write a business case

- Business cases are **critical documents** within organizations and can steer strategic decision-making.
- As such, it's important to understand how to write a business case in a structured, professional manner.
- What should be included in a business case:

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Business Case – cont'd

- 1. Executive summary**
- 2. Background information**
- 3. Project definition**
- 4. Business Requirements**
- 5. Option presentation and evaluation**
- 6. Presentation of preferred option**
- 7. Strategic alignment**
- 8. Benefits**
- 9. Risks**
- 10. Project implementation plan**
- 11. Financial Analysis**
- 12. Resources required**
- 13. Authorizations**
- 14. Appendices**

Technical specifications, environmental impact, Security and Privacy issues must be properly addressed in each step of the business case.

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Business Case – cont'd

1. Executive summary

- Business cases can become hundred-plus-page documents, so it's important to begin with an executive summary.
- The executive summary should include a **brief description** of the business **problem**, **options presented** and the **preferred** option.

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Business Case – cont'd

2. Background information

- Many people will have a **stake in your business case**, and many **may have little or no context for the project**.
- As such, you need to provide background information on the project.
- Background information might include **why** the project needs to take place, **similar projects** that have taken place, and **what has happened** in the lead up to preparing the business case.

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Business Case – cont'd

3. Project definition

- Outline all the **critical details** of your project.
- Describe your project and include details on the business problem that it will solve.

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Business Case – cont'd

4. Business Requirements

- For any given project, there will be several business requirements.
- Specify these requirements and how your project will meet them.

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Business Case – cont'd

5. Option presentation and evaluation

- Show stakeholders that you have researched different options and selected the best one for your business.
- Some business cases require that you conduct research, present a long list of options and then create a shorter list (and a final selection) based on certain criteria.
- For other business cases, all you will need to do is write a short description of options. What is appropriate will depend on the scale of the project.

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Business Case – cont'd

6. Presentation of preferred option

- Present your preferred option.
- Detail **why you have selected** it and **why it best meets** the evaluation criteria.
- Show how it meets business requirements.

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Business Case – cont'd

7. Strategic alignment

- For projects within smaller organizations, it might be obvious how the project aligns with the strategic objectives of a business.
- The strategic alignment section is your chance to demonstrate how your **project actively contributes to your company's broader business** and strategy plans.

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Business Case – cont'd

8. Benefits

- The benefits section is crucial in a business case. Outline the clear benefits of your chosen option.
- The benefits you outline should
 - discuss why the project should proceed in general.
 - outline the **benefits of what you are recommending**, so as to convince stakeholders it is the right option going forward.

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Business Case – cont'd

9. Risks

- As part of the due diligence in writing your business case, you need to present the **risks involved honestly and fairly**.
- Present the risks, including the likelihood that these risks might occur.

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Business Case – cont'd

10. Project implementation plan

- To approve a project, stakeholders want a clear vision of how the project will be implemented. Detail this plan here.
- Give stakeholders a brief insight into how the project will proceed, which stakeholders need to be involved, what resources are required and a timeline.

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Business Case – cont'd

11. Financial Analysis

- It is critical in demonstrating that the project is **affordable to the business**, that they can fund it, and that it will **deliver financial value** in the short and long term.
- Depending on the scale of your project, a simple analysis may be required, or you may need to go into detail and present forecasts and other financial reports.

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Business Case – cont'd

12. Resources required

- Include all resources, including physical assets, intellectual resources, human resources and financial resources that your project will need.

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Business Case – cont'd

13. Authorizations

- The authorizations section details who needs to sign off on what and at what stage.

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Business Case – cont'd

14. Appendices

- Important information that doesn't belong in the body of your business case, such as more detailed research on the options you've presented, **further analysis** of risks and benefits, or more in-depth financial models or project plans.

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Business Case – cont'd

f. How to present a business case

1. Find the **right delivery mode**
2. Prepare an **elevator pitch**
3. Create a **hook**
4. Begin with the business **need**
5. Make it **interactive**
6. **Follow up**

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Business Case – cont'd

f. How to present a business case

1. Find the right delivery mode

- Finding the right delivery mode will ensure that your business case is well received by decision-makers.
- Consider what presentation medium you use.
- Practice your presentation before you deliver it
- Ensuring that you have all these elements right is the first step in presenting your business case.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Business Case – cont'd

f. How to present a business case

2. Prepare an elevator pitch

- Often stakeholders do have time to read the business case, so it's critical to have a **short, sharp elevator pitch** that summarizes it.
- Ensure you have the basics covered with your elevator pitch so stakeholders can make an informed decision.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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Business Case – cont'd

f. How to present a business case

3. Create a hook

- Your business case will contain many critical facts and figures.
- To engage your stakeholders, translate them **into an emotional story**.
- The story will differ from your elevator pitch.
- It will include **how the project will benefit people**.
- Creating a connection through emotion will help you make an impact and be memorable when presenting your business case.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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Business Case – cont'd

f. How to present a business case

4. Begin with the business need

- Every business case should address a **business problem**.
- To get stakeholder buy-in for your business case, start by reminding them of what this problem is so they will have greater incentive to hear about your solution.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Business Case – cont'd

f. How to present a business case

5. Make it interactive

- Interactive presentations are more engaging and memorable.
- Deliver your business case as a discussion.
- Regularly ask questions to specific stakeholders, and ensure you proactively answer any questions asked to you.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Business Case – cont'd

f. How to present a business case

6. Follow up

- It is important, as not everyone may have had time to ask questions or felt comfortable doing so.
- Follow up individually, if possible, to ensure stakeholders have the opportunity to privately voice their concerns.

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1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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Business Case – cont'd

- **Context for a Business case**

The key for developing a strong business case is a **fundamental understanding** of how each of its elements and concepts fit together. In addition, knowledge of the relevant policies, tools, and frameworks referenced throughout the guide can have a dramatic impact on the strategic positioning of the business case and the subsequent delivery of the project.

- **Supporting Policies, Tools, and Frameworks**

The Business Case Guide and Business Case Template have been developed to align with a variety of key instruments and policies. Knowledge and understanding of that underlying context will ensure development of a business case that is strategically well-positioned.

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1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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Business Case – cont'd

- **Business Outcomes**

The business case should clearly illustrate the **desired outcomes** that are to be realized, their alignment with the organization, and how each viable option will support attainment of those outcomes. Business outcomes should be clearly defined, measurable, and developed with stakeholder involvement.

- **Audience for this Guide**

Assembling a business case should be a collaborative effort between stakeholders involved in project delivery and those affected by the outcome of the investment. These stakeholders will include business specialists who understand the business needs to be met and business specialists who understand the costs and risks to be assessed.

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1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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Architecture of a Business Case

Phase	Step	Description	Details
1	1	Business Needs and Desired Outcomes	Establishes the case for change and clearly defines the need for the investment.
2	2	Preliminary Options Analysis	Identification, analysis, and screening of a comprehensive list of options to demonstrate due diligence in the selection of choices.
	3	Viable Options	Builds upon the preliminary analysis of options, where each viable option is subjected to an increasing level of rigorous analysis.
	4	Justification and Recommendation	Full comparison of each viable option against the evaluation criteria identified in the preliminary analysis; and Recommendation of a preferred option based on the net advantages of the viable option over all others.
3	5	Managing the Investment	Strategic considerations for how the investment will be managed .

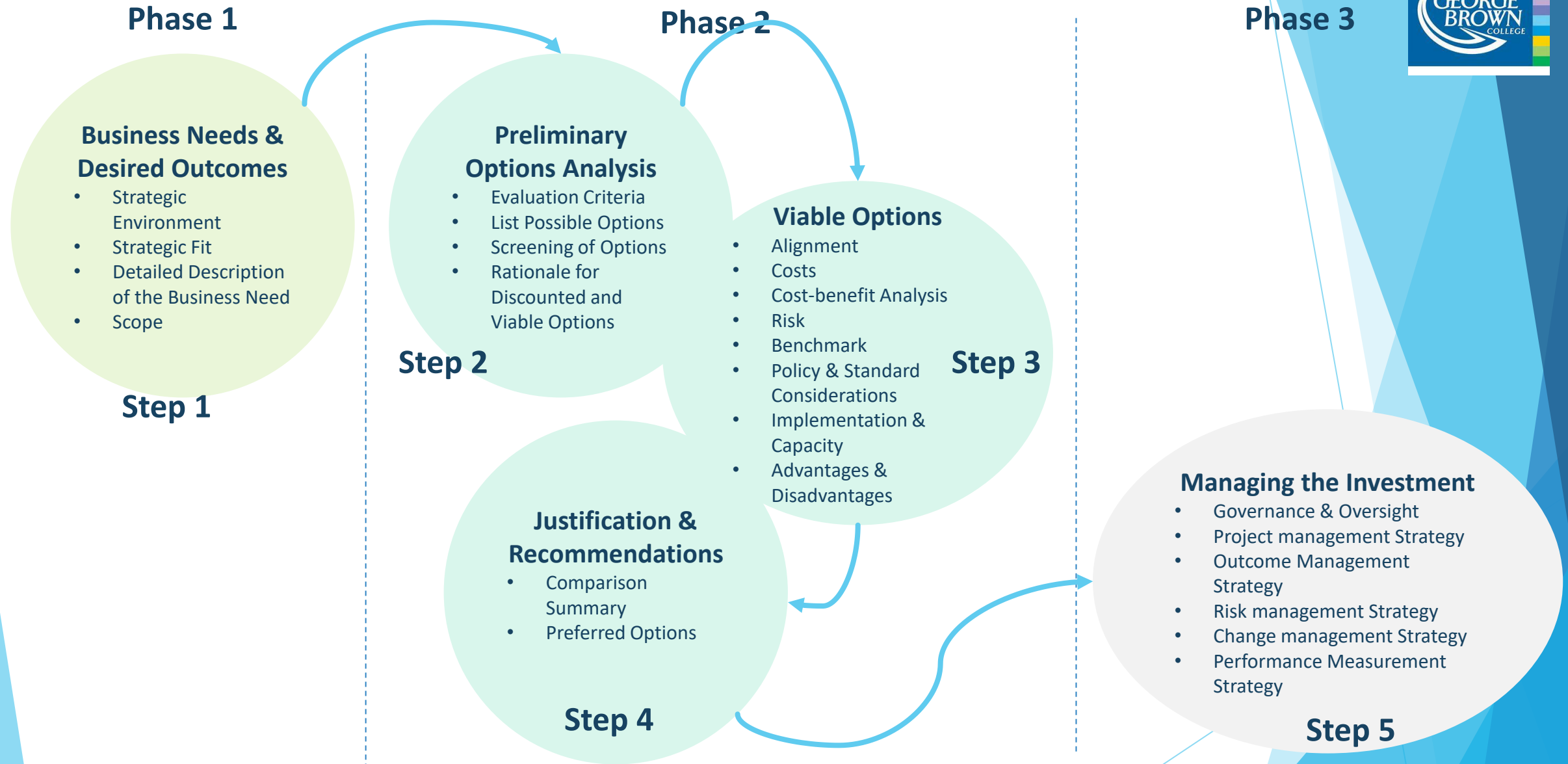
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Phase 1: Strategic Context

- The purpose of the Strategic Context phase is to establish the case for change and clearly define the need for the investment. To do this effectively, the following key questions should be addressed at the outset of every business case:
 - Where are we now? Describes the current business environment.
 - Where do we want to be? Describes the business objectives.
 - What is the business need? Describes the problem or opportunity facing the organization and the associated proposed investment.

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1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

- What has triggered the need for change? Describes the drivers for change.
- What are we trying to achieve? Describes the business' desired outcomes.
- What is the strategic fit? Describes how the proposed investment maps to the departmental framework, to its goals, priorities, outcomes, and policies, as well as to those of the government.

The focus of this phase is on the following:

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

- **Step 1: Business Needs and Desired Outcomes**

- The first step in developing a business case is to **identify the need** (problem or opportunity) facing the sponsoring organization and the desired business outcomes.
- To do this effectively, due consideration should be given to the broader organizational context, which includes the current business environment, strategic business objectives, and drivers for change, along with an analysis of how the desired business outcomes align with the overall organizational objectives, structure, and policy framework.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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Phase 2: Analysis and Recommendation

- The Analysis and Recommendation phase is the point in the business case process where the following key questions should be answered:
 - How will we get there? Presents the viable options and associated costs and benefits that will undergo detailed analysis and the evaluation criteria that ultimately will be used to determine an overall recommendation.
 - What is the best option? This question could be answered by a financial appraisal to ascertain funding, affordability, and cost balancing in relation to benefits and risks.

The focus of this phase is on the following:

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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- **Step 2: Preliminary Options Analysis**

- The next stage focuses on the main options available for addressing the business need.
- Although describing the preliminary range of options at this point does not require a detailed analysis, a comprehensive list of options—sometimes called a “long list”—should be produced and screened to demonstrate due diligence in the selection process.
- Once complete, details regarding the decision to either accept or reject an option for further analysis should be presented to narrow the field of alternatives down to a reasonable number of viable options—sometimes called a “short list” —.
- It is considered a best practice to include a minimum of three viable options for analysis, with one being the status quo option.

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2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O’Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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- **Step 3: Viable Options**

- The objective of Step 3 is to identify the preferred option from the short list of viable options that answer the investment need and the case for change.
- A more rigorous analysis of the viable options is conducted at this point in the business case by building on the previous section's analysis. The advantages and disadvantages (with supporting evidence) of each option should be fully explored and evaluated in terms of their costs (total or incremental) and risks.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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- **Step 4: Justification and Recommendation**

- Nothing in the business case will be questioned or scrutinized more than the justification supporting the recommendation to adopt the preferred option.
- With the detailed analysis of each viable option (including the status quo option) now complete, the goal of Step 4 is to identify a preferred option and demonstrate why the option is deemed preferable over all others.
- This section leverages the Preliminary Options Analysis approach where the options are subjected to a comparative analysis.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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Phase 3: Management and Capacity

- This strategic-level phase should demonstrate to the business case's reviewers that the investment will be managed effectively.
- The reviewers—and all the stakeholders—need assurance that all the appropriate project and outcome management strategies are in place and that they will be used to guide the project through a controlled and well-managed environment to achieve the desired business outcomes.
- Phase 3 will produce the evidence required to strategically address the following key management issues:

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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- Where and how will the investment fit within the organization's broader governance and oversight structure? Describes the governance and oversight structure for the investment.
- How will the project be managed and reviewed throughout its life cycle? Describes the project management strategy for the investment.
- How will the business outcomes be realized? Describes the outcome management strategy for the investment.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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- How will the business risks be mitigated and managed? Describes the risk management strategy for the investment.
- How will change be managed and implemented? Describes the change management strategy for the investment.
- How will performance be measured? Describes the performance measurement strategy for the investment.

The focus of this phase is on the following:

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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- **Step 5: Managing the Investment**

- The important final step in the business case development process, is to describe—at a strategic level—how the investment, project, initiative, or event will be managed, while also demonstrating an acceptable level of due diligence.
- A secondary goal is to further reinforce the key messages of the business case, ensuring its soundness and conformity to commonly acknowledged best practices for business.

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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The following investment management elements should be described in terms of strategies and illustrate that such critical project management fundamentals as methodology and procedures are well thought out and in place before the launch of the project:

- Governance and oversight
- Project management strategy
- Outcome management strategy
- Risk management strategy
- Change management strategy
- Performance measurement strategy

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2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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Phase 1: Strategic Context

Step 1: Business Needs and Desired Outcomes

1.1 Strategic Environment

1.1.1 Organizational Overview

1.1.2 Business Need

1.1.3 Drivers for Change

1.1.4 Business Outcomes

1.2 Strategic Fit

1.2.1 Strategic alignment

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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1.3 Detailed Description of the Business Need

1.3.1 Problem/Opportunity Statement

1.3.2 Prioritized Requirements (High Level)

1.3.3 Assumptions

1.3.4 Constraints

1.3.5 Dependencies

1.4 Scope

1.4.1 Boundaries

1.4.2 Stakeholder Analysis

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Summary: after completing Phase 1 of the business case, you should be able to answer the following questions:

- Where are we now?
- Where do we want to be?
- What is the business need?
- What has triggered the need for change?
- What are we trying to achieve?
- What is the strategic fit?

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Phase 2: Analysis and Recommendation

Step 2: Preliminary Options Analysis

2.1 Evaluation Criteria

- 1) Screening criteria (deal breakers)
- 2) Essential evaluation criteria (minimum requirement)
- 3) Desirable evaluation criteria (non-essential)

2.2 List of Possible Options

2.2.1 The Status Quo

2.2.2 Describing the Option

2.3 Screening of Options

2.4 Rationale for Discounted and Viable Options

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1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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Step 3: Viable Options

3.1 Alignment

3.1.1 Strategic Alignment

3.1.2 Alignment with Desired Business Outcomes

3.2 Costs

3.3 Cost-Benefit Analysis

3.4 Implementation and Capacity Considerations of Viable Options

3.4.1 Contracting and Procurement

3.4.2 Schedule and Approach

3.4.3 Impact

3.4.4 Capacity

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

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3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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3.5 Risk

3.5.1 Option Risk Summary

3.5.2 Risk Register

3.6 Benchmark

3.7 Policy and Standard Considerations

3.8 Advantages and Disadvantages

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

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Step 4: Justification and Recommendation

4.1 Comparison Summary

4.2 The Preferred Option

4.2.1 Recommendation

4.2.2 Deciding Factors

4.2.3 Costs

4.2.4 Risks

4.2.5 Implementation Plan

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3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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Summary

After completing Phase 2 Step 4 of the business case, you should be able to answer the following questions:

- How will we get there?
- What is the best option?

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2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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Phase 3: Management and Capacity

Step 5: Managing the Investment

5.1 Governance and Oversight

5.2 Project Management Strategy

5.2.1 Project Review Strategy

5.3 Outcome Management Strategy

5.4 Risk Management Strategy

5.5 Change Management Strategy

5.6 Performance Measurement Strategy

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3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Summary

After completing Phase 3 of the business case, you should be able to answer the following questions:

- Where and how will the investment fit within the organization's broader governance and oversight structure?
- How will the project be managed and reviewed throughout its life cycle?
- How will the business outcomes be realized?
- How will the business risks be mitigated and managed?
- How will change be managed and implemented?
- How will performance be measured?

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3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Business case resources

The Government of Canada, however, is not the only organization addressing how to optimize benefits from investments. Reference to the work of the following organizations can also be found in this document:

- Office of Government Commerce, UK
- Office of Management and Budget, US
- Australian Government Information Management Office
- New Zealand Ministry of Health
- MIT Sloan Management Review, McKinsey & Co., Inc.
- Project Management Institute

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

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3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

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Business case resources – cont'd

When learning how to write a business case, it's helpful to have best-practice templates to work with. Here are some resources you can use:

- [Business Case Template - Canada.ca](#)
- [Business Case Guide - Canada.ca](#)
- [Business plan template for entrepreneurs | BDC.ca](#)
- [Smartsheet](#) numerous business case templates

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

3 – Wikipedia , The free encyclopedia

4 – The Art Of The Start, Guy Kawasaki Portfolio, Published by Penguin Group, Copyright © Guy Kawasaki, 2004

Business case resources – cont'd

Bibliography

- **Data Science for Business**, what you need to know about data mining and data-analytic thinking, by Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright© 2013, Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.
- **The Art of the Start**, the time-tested, battle-hardened guide for anyone starting anything, by Guy Kawasaki, published by Penguin Group, Copyright© 2004, **Guy Kawasaki**. All rights reserved.
- **Hurdle, The Book On Business Panning**, Planning for Success, A step-by-step guide to creating a thorough, concrete and concise business plan, by **Tom Berry**, published by Palo Alto Inc, Copyright© 2006, Timothy J. Berry. All rights reserved.
- **How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online**

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

1 – How To Write A Business Case: Tips, Resources and Examples | JCU Online

2 – Data Science for Busin4ess, Foster Provost & Tom Fawcett, Published by O'Reilly Media Inc., Copyright © 2013 Foster Provost and Tom Fawcett. All rights reserved.

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